



1. BELIEF IN ONENESS OF ALLAH / TAUHEED:

Belief in the oneness of Allah is the fundamental teaching of Islam. It is the foundation of faith and termed Tauhid. Allah is the One and the Only God. He is the Creator, the Sustainer of the heaven, the earth and everything therein, "Allah is the Creator of all things and He is the Guardian and Disposer of all affairs. To Him belong the keys of the heavens and the earth." (Az-Z'umar:62-63) No one has any share in His ownership or authority.

at beginning or an end, He is the First and the Last "He is the First and the Last, the Evident, and the Immanent."

Tauhid has Three Aspects:

1. Oneness of the Lordship of Allah

There is only One Lord for the entire universe that is Allah. He is the Creator, the Organizer, the Supreme Planner, the Sustainer, the Law-Giver, the Designer, and the Giver of the security etc. He is neither father nor son of anyone, Allah says, "Say, He is Allah the One and Only, Allah the Eternal Absolute. He begets not nor is He begotten." (Ikhlas 112:3)

Again, "And your Allah is one Allah, there is no god but He, the Most Gracious, Most Merciful". (Al-Baqarah 2:163)

2. Oneness in Worship of Allah

Since, Allah is the Creator; He is the only one worthy of worship. It is man's primary duty says, "O you people! Worship your Guardian-Lord who created you and those who came before you that you may have the chance to learn righteousness". (Al-Baqarah 2:21)

Again He says, "I have only created jinn and men that they may serve Me." (Adh-Dhariyat 51:56)

None has the right to be worshipped but Allah. We must only pray, invoke and ask Him for help from the unseen. We swear by His name. We offer sacrifice, give charity, fast and perform pilgrimage for Allah. Allah says, "You do we worship and Your aid we seek." (Al-Fatihah 1:5)

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3. Oneness of the Names and Attributes of Allah

We must not name or qualify Allah except with what He and His Messenger has named or qualified him. None can be named or qualified with the names or qualifications of Allah e.g., "And there is none like unto Him." (Al-Ikhlās 112:5)

SHIRK:

Shirk literally means partnership or sharing or associating but in terminology of Islam it refers to assigning partners to Allah, or ascribing Divine attribute to others beside Allah and believing that the source of power, harm and blessings comes from others beside Allah. It is opposite of Tauhid, it is the biggest, unforgivable sin, Allah says, "Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with him, but He forgives anything else to whom He pleases". (Al-Nisa 4:48) Again He says, "Whoever joins other gods with Allah. Allah will forbid him the garden and the Fire will be his abode. There will for the wrong-doers be no one to help". (Al-Maidah:72)

Shirk is also divided into three main categories:

A. Shirk in the existence of Allah: To associate partner in oneness of Allah, to think that there is more than one creator, or declare that he is father or son to anyone, Allah says, "Neither He begets nor He is, begotten." (Ikhlās 112:3)

B. Shirk in attributes: To ascribe any of the unique qualities and attributes of Allah to any other being. To claim or believe that any other being possess the same knowledge, divine power, will or determination of Allah, or he can create, or make someone die or perish or give, or benefit or harm.

C. Shirk in worship: To associate partners in worship with Allah. Allah is the Creator, the Sustainer and the Provider, He is alone worthy of worship, Allah says, "Your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him". (Isrā 17:23). Again He says, "And your Allah is one Allah; there is no god but He, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful." (Al-Baqarah:163). Praying, Invoking, or asking for help from unseen, swearing, offering sacrifice, giving charity, slaughtering in the name of other than Allah is shirk.

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2.BELIEF IN ANGELS:

Belief in angels is the second articles of faith. Angels are special creation of Allah and are made of light (Nur). The angels are a link between man and God, Allah says, "Whoever is an enemy to Allah and His angels and apostles to Gabriel and Michael Lo! Allah is an enemy to those who reject faith." (Baqarah 2:98)

Some of the angels have two wings, some three and some four. They arrange themselves in ranks and are strong in repelling evil. Angels do not have any knowledge except what Allah has given them.

Unlike Human beings and Jinns, angels are not endowed with Freewill. They are absolutely obedient to Allah's commands and follow them without any hesitation.

They strengthen heart of righteous believers. In the battle of Badr angels strengthened the heart of believers, helped them and fought by their side. They cast terror into hearts of non believers. They ask Allah's forgiveness for believers and send blessings on them.

They act as messengers of Allah, but they do not descend without His permission, "Therein come down the angels and the Spirit by Allah's permission on every errand." (97:4)

An angel was sent to prophet Zakariyya AS and to Maryam AS to give them tiding of a son. An Angel also appeared to the prophet Ibrahim in human form to give him glad tiding of a son.

A person who believes in angels feels grateful to Allah for the blessing that He has made this creation, and commanded it to serve us, protect us and seek forgiveness for us.

The belief that the angels are recording our deeds, makes us careful regarding all our thoughts, words and actions. The fact that Allah made the angels prostrate before Adam, elevates our status as human beings and makes us feel responsible towards all our duties.

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The fact that Allah sends Jibraeel and the other angels down on every Night of Power (Laila-tul-Qadr), strengthens our bond with our Creator.

The most prominent angels are:

Angel Gabriel is the one who brought the message of Allah to Muhammad PBUH and all the other prophets.

Angel Israfeel will blow the trumpet on the Day of Judgment, and then again he will blow it when people will be resurrected.

Angel Izrael is the angel of death who takes away life.

Angel Mikael provides provisions to people; he is also responsible for rainfall.

Angel Rizwan is the keeper of Paradise.

Angel Malik is the keeper of Hell.

Kiram -il Kattibin record the deeds of a person, Allah says, "But verily over you (are appointed angels) to protect you, kind and honourable writing down (your deeds)." (Al-Infitar 82:10)

Munkar and Nakir question the dead in grave, about his belief in Allah and His Last Messenger PBUH.



3.BELIEF IN DIVINE BOOKS:

Belief in the Divine books of Allah is one of the fundamental beliefs of Islam. Allah sent His guidance for mankind through His Prophets who were guided through these Divine Books. All these Divine scriptures carried the same message, i.e., about the Oneness of Allah, His Lordship over everything and that people must serve Him alone.

"....There is god but He, the Creator of all things, then worship Him and He has power to dispose off all affairs." (Surah Al-Anaam:102)

The revealed books mentioned in the Qur'an are:-

1. **The Zabur (Psalms)** was revealed to Dawood (AS)
2. **The Torah** was revealed to Musa (AS) for the guidance of Bani Israel. It contained Allah's command, light, admonition, mercy, and a clear explanation of things. The original book was changed; its followers distorted it and perverted words of Allah and changed its meaning, Allah says, "They change the words from their (right) places and forget a good part of the Message that was sent". (Al-Maidah 5:13)
3. **The Injeel (Bible)** was sent to Isa (AS). The Christians distorted the Bible and introduced doctrine of "trinity" and redemption through crucifixion, although Isa had clearly told his followers that Allah was his Lord and their lord and they should worship Allah alone. According to the Qur'an Injeel confirms the Torah. The Prophet Muhammad is mentioned in both the Injil and the Torah. Allah says, "And remember Jesus the son of Mary said: "O Children of Israel! I am the apostle of Allah (sent) to you confirming the Law (which came) before me and giving glad Tidings of an Apostle to come after me whose name shall be Ahmad." (As-Saff 61:6)
4. **The Qur'an** was revealed to Muhammad (PBUH)
5. The Qur'an also mentions the ***Suhaf (scroll) of Ibrahim(AS)***.

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All Divine books invited people to worship Allah, they contained belief in prophethood, the Day of Judgment and the concept of reward and punishment, and they also contained a code of morality and justice.

Superiority of the Qur'an to Early Scriptures

None of the revealed Books except the Qur'an exists in its original form today. The Suhaf of Ibrahim was lost. Some of the books were changed and modified such as Torah and Injil. God's words have been blended with those of man, thus it is difficult to establish the authenticity of various parts of these Books.

The Qur'an is the message of Allah, it requires belief not only in its own truth but also in the truth of the previous scriptures revealed to other prophets, Allah says, "And who believe in the Revelation sent to you and sent before your time and (in their hearts) has the assurance of the Hereafter." (Al-Baqarah 2:4) The origin of the Qur'an and the other and that Divine books is the same; they are all from Allah.

The Qur'an accepts the truth of all divine books sent down to the other prophets, and verifies what was before it. The Qur'an safeguards and preserves teachings of earlier books. It watches over the revelations that God had sent earlier by explaining their true meanings and negates any confusion, misunderstanding, or misinterpretation that have arisen.

Also Allah has taken the responsibility for the preservation of Quran, "We have, without doubt, sent down the Message; and We will surely guard it (from corruption)." (Surah Al-Hijr:9)

Arabic, the language of Qur'an is a living language, spoken, and understood by millions of people all over the world, while the languages of other books are dead languages. "We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'an in order that you may learn wisdom." (12:2)

The Qur'an is a universal book addressed to all people of all ages. "We have explained in this Qur'an for the benefit of mankind." (Az-Z'Umar 39:2). While the other old books were revealed to particular nations for a particular period.

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ARTICLES OF FAITH

The Qur'an is the last and perfect Book of Allah. It is a comprehensive book. It deals with every aspect of human life; social, economic, legal, moral, etc. Allah says, "This day I have perfected your religion for you, completed My favours upon you, and chosen for you Islam as your religion." (Al-Maidah 5:3).

The earlier books contained only a code of morality and justice, but none was comprehensive to contain a complete code of life.

There is proof about the authenticity of Qur'an, and even of the places and occasions when they were revealed, but there is no historical evidence to the authenticity of the early books.

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4.BELIEF IN PROPHETS:

From the beginning of the history of mankind, human beings have received from time to time, commandments from Allah to guide them and protect them from sins and to direct their worldly and religious affairs.

The Muslim belief is that this communication has been done through his Prophets who were all human beings, chosen by Allah and had the honour of conveying Allah's message to their people.

Since Allah is the Benefactor and Giver of blessings to His creations, it is mandatory that the people should give proper thanks to Him. However, since they were unaware of how to show this appreciation and give proper thanks to Allah, He sent Prophets to show them the correct way.

According to some traditions, 124000 prophets were sent to the mankind. The Qur'an only mentions 26 of them. Muslims believe in all prophets. They respect them all and make no distinction between one prophet and other. They believe in Moses, Jesus, Jacob, Abraham, Solomon and every other prophet that appeared in every part of the world as they all brought the same message of Islam, Allah says, "We believe in Allah and the revelation given to us and to Abraham, Isma'il, Isaac, Jacob and the Tribes and that given to Moses and Jesus and that given to (all) prophets from their Lord, we make no difference between one and another of them." (Al-Baqarah 2:136)

The messages of all the prophets are same, they all preached Islam and invited people to Oneness of Allah. Allah says, "It is He who has sent His Apostle with Guidance and the Religion of Truth that he may proclaim it over all religion". (Al-An'am 61:9) They gave tidings of paradise to those who abide by the commands of Allah, and warned the people about the consequences of their evil deeds and about hell. "O Prophet! Lo! We have sent you as a witness and a bringer of good tidings and a warner." (Al-Ahzab 33:45)

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Prophets were normal human beings. They had wives and children. They were men of great piety and model of good conduct. They were all truthful and honest people. They were sin-less.

A prophet was sent to every and every people. Allah says, "And for every nation there is a messenger." (Yunus 10:47). Every prophet spoke the language of his people, "We sent an apostle except (to teach) in the language of his (own) people in order to make (things) clear to them". (14:4).

Although it was their duty to convey the message of truth, the Prophets were not responsible for people's reactions to it, after they had made it clear to them. Guidance can only be given by Allah. Hence the Prophets did not have such powers, and could not therefore, persuade many of those whom they cared for.

For example, neither Nuh could force his own son to accept the Message of Allah nor Lut could guide his wife. Similarly, the Prophet PBUH could not convince his uncle, Abu Talib to accept Islam although he supported him throughout his mission in Makkah. It makes a believer responsible for all his worldly and religious affairs, since he has been rightly guided in every possible way.



5.BELIEF IN DAY OF JUDGEMENT / QAYAMAT & RESSURECTION:

Belief in Qayamat (Doomsday) is one of the most important parts of the articles of faith. Muslims believe that Qayamat will come when Israfeel will blow the trumpet. At the first blast of the trumpet, the earth will be badly shaken, and all the buildings and mountains will be levelled. The sun will be darkened, the stars will fall and seas will overflow and then dry up.

The sound of the trumpet will be so severe that everything on earth will perish. No one will remain alive. As to when shall the Doomsday come, the Muslims believe that no one knows about it except Allah. Life will end at an appointed day. Everything in this universe shall be destroyed. The day is called Qayamah.

Qayamah will be the day of clamour and noise. People will be running about in great confusion and bewilderment, Allah says, "(It is) a Day whereon Men will be like moths Scattered about. And the mountains will be like carded wool." (Al-Qari'ah 101:4-5)

Mothers will forget their children; everyone will be concerned about his own self, Allah says, "The Day you shall see, every mother giving suck shall forget her suckling-baby and every pregnant female shall drop her load (unformed). (Al-Hajj 22:2)

Again, He says, "When the deafening blast is sounded that day man shall flee from his brother, his mother, and his father". (Al-Abas 80:33-35)

The sun will be folded up; stars will lose their light and scatter away. The earth will rent asunder. Mountains will set in motion and they will be blown away.

"One Day We shall remove the mountains and you will see the earth as a level stretch." (20.100) Oceans will boil over and burst forth. All will die, Allah says, "Every soul must taste of death." (Al-Anbiyaa 21:35)

Souls rest in Barzakh till the day of resurrection, Allah says "Before them is a partition (Burzakh) till the day they are raised up". (Al-Muminun 23:100)

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RESSURECTION

The second trumpet will be blown and there will be resurrection not only of men but also of angels, Jinn, beasts, birds and everything that existed in this world. "Then will a second one be sounded when behold they will be standing and looking on! And the Earth will shine with the glory of its Lord: the Record (of Deeds) will be placed (open)" (68-69 Az-Z'Umar).

A new world will emerge with a new sky. All human beings who had lived on this earth since its inception will come back to life, this is called HASHR.

Scales will be set up, and the deeds will be weighed, Allah says, "We shall set up scales of justice for the Day of Judgment so that not a soul will be dealt with unjustly in the least. And if there be (no more than) the weight of a mustard seed We will bring it (to account)". (Al-Anbiyaa:42)

As-Sirat (the bridge) will be laid across Hell and Muhammad PBUH shall be the first amongst the Apostles to cross it with his followers. Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri narrated "We, the Companions of the Prophet said, "O Allah's Apostle! What is the bridge?' He said, "It is a slippery (bridge) on which there are clamps and (Hooks like) a thorny seed that is wide at one side and narrow at the other and has thorns with bent ends. ... Some of the believers will cross the bridge as quickly as the wink of an eye, some others as quick as lightning, a strong wind, fast horses or she-camels. So some will be safe without any harm; some will be safe after receiving some scratches, and some will fall down into Hell. The last person will cross by being dragged over the bridge." (Sahih Bukhari)



6.BELIEF IN PREDESTINATION

(DIVINE DECREE):

A Muslim believes in predestination, everything is ordained by Allah, He determines fate of a while he is still in the womb of his mother. Everything that happened, everything that is person happening and everything that will take place has been determined by Allah, Allah says, "Verily all things have We created in proportion and measure". (Al-Qamar 54:49)

Allah's Creation is not haphazard. Everything goes by law, proportion, and measure. Everything has its appointed time, place, and occasion, as Allah says "No misfortune can happen on earth or in your souls but is recorded in a decree before We bring it into existence: that is truly easy for Allah." (Al-Hadid 57:22)

We should keep in mind that Allah has created us with free will and ability to choose, the ability must work within us, Allah say, "Man can have nothing but what he strives for."(an-Najm 53:39)

Thus one cannot claim to have complete faith in Islam if he does not believe in the Divine Will and Decree. Every human being must believe that he is held accountable for what Allah has willed for him since every person has been granted the freedom of choice.

It is possible that Allah sends a daily/yearly decree dictating that a person will get a profit. However, due to that person's good deeds (for instance, fulfilling the ties of kinship [being good to your relatives and maintaining the relationship]), Allah sends another decree, increasing that person's profit.

The reversal of the two decrees is all within Allah's knowledge and is recorded in the Preserved Tablet. Another example of reversal of decree is evident from the story of Prophet Yunus Initially, when his people did not pay any heed to his warnings, Allah decreed punishment for them. On witnessing His impending wrath, the entire population of

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Ninevah gathered on a mountaintop and begged for His forgiveness. Allah accepted their repentance and removed the wrath that was hanging ominously over their heads. Allah says in the Qur'an:

"When they believed, We removed from them the punishment of disgrace in worldly life and gave them enjoyment for a time." (Surah Yunus, Verse: 98)

A Muslim who believes in Predestination and Divine Decree will have his mind at ease, he would not fear anybody because he knows that no one has the power to afflict harm on him without it being decreed by Allah.

It teaches the Muslim to be modest and humble because he knows that everything that happens, is by the Will of Allah. This also avoids pride from getting into his heart because he knows that Allah can deprive him of the bounties.